5.2.2. Soft diets:

A soft diet is soft in texture and consists of liquid and semi solid foods. The food in this diet may be liquid, chopped, pureed or regular foods with a very soft consistency. A soft diet is made up of simple, easily digestable food and contains no harsh fibre, low in fat and not rich and highly seasoned food. It is often modified further for certain pathological conditions as bland and low residue diet. This diet gives 1500kcal and 35-40g of protein. A light diet is given before regular diet.

Soft Diet

Definition:

- It is an adequate diet that is soft in consistancy, easy to chew, made up of simple easy digestible foods, It is appropriate for patients who have few or no teeth or ill-fitting dentures.

Indication:

- Acute Infections
- Certain gastrointestinal disorders and at the post operative stage

Salient features of soft diets are:

- ❖ It includes foods low in indigestible dietary fibre.
- ❖ Foods that can be mashed with a fork are included.
- ❖ Cooked fruits and vegetables, bananas, soft eggs and tender meats are included.
- ❖ Most raw fruits and vegetables, fried foods or foods containing seeds and dried fruits are avoided.
- ❖ Vegetables can be pureed and meats are ground for dental patients.
- ❖ Little or no spices are used in its preparation.
- ❖ A soft diet includes all liquids & Juices.
- ❖ A soft diet consist of well-cooked cereals, pastas, white bread, eggs, cheese, tender meat, fish, poultry and vegetables.
- ❖ Permitted desserts are custards, gelatin puddings, soft fruits, simple cakes and cookies.









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